

Overview of B2 First for Schools Listening Paper

Aims of the lesson	To familiarise students with the contents of the Listening Test (Paper 3).
Time needed	30 minutes
Materials required	Classroom handout 1 (one per student)

Procedure

1. Divide the class into teams of 5 or 6 students.
2. Give each student a copy of **Classroom handout 1**, which contains information about the B2 First for Schools Listening Paper.
3. Write the following numbers on the board, or dictate them for students to write down.

1	2	3	4	5	7
8	10	20	30	40	

Timing: 3 mins

4. Ask the teams to write questions based on the information in the **Classroom handout 1** to which these numbers are the answers. Sometimes there is more than one possible question – teams should write as many questions as possible, so they may well write more than one question for a number.

Timing: 10 mins

5. Ask the teams to read out their questions to the class, so the other teams can answer. Ask the students to turn over **Classroom handout 1** at this stage, so they can see how much they can remember. Give a team one point for each correct and correctly formulated question. (See **Answers to Classroom handout 1**.)

Timing: 10 mins

Accept any correct questions – the students will be able to familiarise themselves with the details of the different parts of the Listening Papers in activities relating to those parts.

Follow up: Ask the class if they have any other questions. Have your Teacher's Handbook ready just in case they ask any difficult questions.

Classroom handout 1

Paper 3 contains four parts and there are 30 questions in total.

In Part 1, the multiple-choice section, you will hear eight short, unrelated extracts of about 30 seconds each. After each extract, you will have to answer a multiple-choice question by selecting one of three options.

In Part 2, you will hear a monologue (just one person speaking), which lasts about 3 minutes. You have to complete 10 sentences with the information you hear.

In Part 3, multiple matching, you will hear five short related monologues of about 30 seconds each. You must then choose the correct answer for each of the five questions from eight possible options.

In Part 4, you will hear a dialogue lasting about 3 minutes. There are seven multiple-choice questions, with three options each.

There is always the same number of questions in every Listening Paper. You will always hear each section twice, and the test lasts about 40 minutes.

You have to write all your answers on a separate answer sheet. You can write on the question paper as you listen, but you must transfer answers to the answer sheet. You will get five minutes at the end of the test to do this. You have to shade the correct lozenge or write out your answers for Part 2.

Each question is worth 1 mark. The total score is then adjusted to give a mark out of 40, which is 20% of the total exam. Parts 1, 3 and 4 are marked by computer; Part 2 is marked by trained markers.

Answers to Classroom handout 1

Possible questions – accept any others which are correct.

- 1: How many marks are given for each correct answer? Which part consists of eight extracts?
- 2: How many times do candidates hear each section? Which part is not marked by computer?
- 3: How many minutes do the recordings last in Parts 2 and 4? How many options are there in the multiple-choice questions? How many parts are marked by computer?
- 4: How many parts are there in the Listening Paper?
- 5: How many questions are there in Part 3?
How many minutes do we have to transfer our answers to the answer sheet?
- 7: How many multiple-choice questions are there in Part 4?
- 8: How many extracts are there in Part 1? How many options are there in Part 3?
- 10: How many sentences are there to complete in Part 2?
- 20: What percentage of the total marks is the Listening Test mark?
- 30: How many questions are there in total?
How long in seconds are the extracts in Part 1?
- 40: How (many minutes) long is the Listening Test? What is the final mark out of?